Experiment 10: Getting Started with Zoho Creator: Account Setup and Building a Form-Based Application

Aim

To create a Zoho Creator account and build a simple form-based application, the **Leave Management System**.

Objective

- Set up a Zoho account and open Zoho Creator.
- Create a new application from scratch.
- Design a form with different field types.
- Submit sample records and view them in the default report.

Requirements

A computer with internet access, a modern browser and an e-mail address for signing up.

Procedure

A. Account setup

1. Open `creator.zoho.com` and click **Sign up for free**.
2. Enter your name, e-mail and password, accept the terms and verify the e-mail.
3. Choose the data centre / region when asked and sign in to the Creator dashboard.

B. Create the application

1. Click **Create Application** and select **Start from scratch**.
2. Enter the application name **Leave Management System** and click Create.

C. Build the form

1. Choose **Create a form from scratch** and name it **Leave Request**.
2. Drag the fields from the left panel into the form as given in the table below.
3. Set *Employee Name*, *From Date*, *To Date* and *Leave Type* as mandatory under Field Properties.
4. Set the default value of *Status* to Pending.
5. Click **Save**, then **Access Application**.

Field Name	Field Type	Settings
Employee Name	Name / Single Line	Mandatory
Employee ID	Single Line	Unique values
Department	Dropdown	HR, Finance, IT, Sales
Leave Type	Radio	Casual, Sick, Earned
From Date	Date	Mandatory
To Date	Date	Mandatory
Reason	Multi Line	Optional
Status	Dropdown	Pending, Approved, Rejected (default Pending)

D. Test the application

1. Click **Access Application** to open the live version.
2. Fill the Leave Request form with 3 to 4 sample records and click Submit.
3. Open the **Leave Request Report** and confirm the records appear.

Attach screenshot here - Leave Request form in the builder

Attach screenshot here - Report showing submitted records

Results

A Zoho account was created and the Leave Management System application was built with a Leave Request form. Records submitted through the form were stored and displayed in the default report.

Conclusion

Zoho Creator allows a working data-entry application to be built in minutes using drag-and-drop fields, without writing any code. This form is the base for the pages, reports and workflows built in the next experiments.